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E-MAIL, DESI ISHTYLE!

Regional language e-mail and chat are here to enhance your Internet experience. So log on and reach out...language is no bar!

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Tired of hearing your grandma complaining about how difficult it is for her to read your *angrezi* e-mail? Don't fret, for help is at hand in the form of various sites offering e-mail in regional languages. Yes, you can now send e-mail in Indian languages like Hindi, Marathi, Gujarathi, Bengali, Malayalam, etc.

Check out what technology has in store for people who are more comfortable communicating in their mother tongue.

Regional language e-mail sites

Some of the major Indian sites offering these facilities are www.epatra.com, www.mailjol.com, www.rediff.com, www.mail.sify.com, www.jagran.com, etc.

A US-based site, www.langoo.com, offers e-mail in Indian as well as several international languages. All these sites offer Hindi and some even offer up to 12 or more regional languages.

These sites make use of a technique called transliteration for conversion of English characters to regional language fonts (*see box: 'Transliteration', for more details on how it works*).

Epatra.com

Epatra is one of the best Indian sites offering regional language e-mail services. It currently has 11 regional languages on its menu—Hindi, Marathi, Gujarati, Punjabi, Malayalam, Assamese, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, and Oriya.

Registration is easy, after which you can start firing e-mail in any (or all) of the 11 languages. Epatra also has features like chat in regional languages, *kamna* cards, discussion forums, news, etc (*see box: 'Get that Epatra Going'*). To help you compose your message in the regional language, epatra has a typing assistant that shows you the correct combination of English characters to get the regional language character.

Mailjol.com

Mailjol is similar to epatra and also features 11 languages. It is easy for even a novice to figure out the interface. Download and install the software component, and you are ready to go. The main difference in features between mailjol and epatra is that in mailjol, you just have to click on regional language characters from a table for them to appear in the message. It also features a typing assistant similar to the one on epatra.

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